

Chapter 34 - Part 8

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Xu Qingzhu locked herself in the study all morning, wanting to contact Bai Weiwei multiple times, but then pulling her hand back.

The contact information was right there, but she didn't know what to say.

After hesitating and wavering, she sent a text message: [Are you feeling better?]

Bai Weiwei didn't reply until the afternoon.

Liang Shi cooked lunch, and to satisfy the little girl's sweet tooth, she made a table full of sweet dishes.

Fish-flavored shredded pork¹, kung pao chicken², and many pretty little cakes.

When Xu Qingzhu came out of the study, Little Bell was still complaining: "Auntie, why are there no strawberry cakes? Don't you have any strawberries at home? I don't want to eat mango ones."

Liang Shi said: "Your aunt-in-law is allergic to strawberries."

Little Bell's face fell: "Okay."

The three of them had lunch together. Liang Shi made four dishes and a soup, and her cooking skills were indeed excellent.

After eating, there were also desserts.

Xu Qingzhu was too lazy to ask her why she had suddenly mastered dessert-making skills.

She couldn't get any answers anyway, and after chatting with Zhao Xuning, she had decided to restrain her curiosity.

Curiosity killed the cat.

After eating a lunch that was sickeningly sweet, Xu Qingzhu and Liang Shi took Little Bell, who couldn't sit still for a moment, for a walk in the back garden.

Little Bell stretched out her hand to touch the wind and sighed: "The weather is so nice today!"

Liang Shi suddenly thought: "Little Bell, do you want to fly a kite?"

"Do you have one at home?" Little Bell asked.

Liang Shi shook her head: "No, but we can make a paper kite."

Little Bell was surprised: "You know how?"

Liang Shi: "...I can learn."

What she meant by "learn" was finding a tutorial online, then going to the utility room at home to find a pile of materials, sitting on the living room floor with Little Bell, and starting to follow the tutorial step by step.

In the end, of course... she failed to learn it.

The paper kite that came out looked like a pile of mud—completely hopeless.

It couldn't fly at all.

Seeing Little Bell's disappointed expression, Liang Shi immediately said: "How about I take you to buy one?"

Little Bell's eyes lit up: "Great!"

"Auntie, can I have a strawberry cake?" Little Bell said.

Liang Shi hesitated, glancing at Xu Qingzhu. Xu Qingzhu said: "Don't look at me. It's fine to eat it outside."

"Okay." Liang Shi agreed.

"Then, then, then!" Little Bell gradually pushed her luck: "Can I have an ice cream? Just one scoop!"

Liang Shi: "No, your mom said you can't have ice cream today."

Little Bell's face immediately fell, pouting and pretending to sniffle pitifully: "Okay."

Liang Shi: "..."

Little Bell peeked at her, then reached out her soft little hand to tug at her clothes, her voice soft and sweet: "Auntie, really can't I?"

She held up one finger with her other hand, looking at Liang Shi pitifully with her grape-purple eyes: "Just one scoop, please?"

Liang Shi looked troubled and glanced at Xu Qingzhu again.

So Little Bell switched tactics, tugging at Xu Qingzhu's sleeve with her free hand: "Aunt-in-law, please?"

Xu Qingzhu: "..."

No one could resist the coquettish offensive of a human cub.

Both of them were defeated, but they negotiated with Little Bell that she could only have one.

Little Bell happily agreed.

When they went out, Xu Qingzhu watched the backs of Liang Shi holding Little Bell's hand and thought to herself: This person will probably become a total daughter-slave³ in the future.

After thinking this, she shook her head.

It had nothing to do with her.

Footnotes:

¹ Fish-flavored shredded pork: A popular Sichuan dish that actually contains no fish, but uses seasonings traditionally used for fish dishes

² Kung pao chicken: A classic Chinese dish with chicken, peanuts, and chili peppers

³ Daughter-slave: A Chinese term for fathers (or in this case, parents) who are completely devoted to and spoil their daughters